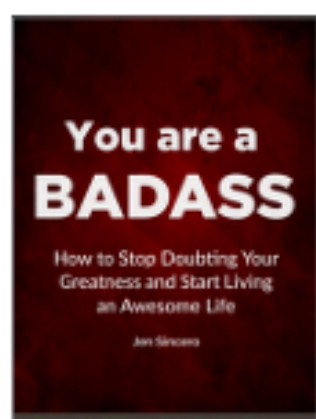




YOU ARE A BADASS

How to Stop Doubting Your Greatness
and Start Living an Awesome Life

Jen Sincero



The Big “So What”

Most people cruise through life. They earn enough to make pay their bills and occasionally dream of a better life. Yet, they don't actually do what it takes to realize their dreams and goals. This book explains how you can embrace your greatness, unlock your potential, and start living the life you've always wanted.



Introduction



The author, Jen Sincero, was broke despite being a published author. She wanted to start living to her full potential, so she embarked on a self-improvement journey and immersed herself in self-help books, courses and programs. This book, written in 27 chapters, captures the best of what Sincero learned, including how she overcame her limiting beliefs, built her confidence, reached for her dreams, and multiplied her income.

- Her main message is this: You are a Badass. You can conquer any challenge and achieve anything you want, if you truly set your heart and mind to it. However, don't just wish for change. Make a real, non-negotiable decision to start living your best life.
- To achieve results you've not achieved before, you must be willing to get uncomfortable and do what you've not done before. Sincero asks that you keep an open mind, and at least apply the ideas to truly appreciate how they can work for you.
- In this summary, we'll examine the factors holding you back from your best life, before looking at how you can unlock your inner Badass.

KEY QUOTES

"You need to go from wanting to change your life to deciding to change your life."

"If you want to live a life you've never lived, you have to do things you've never done."



What's Holding You Back?



Limiting Beliefs and The Subconscious Mind



Our beliefs determine how we perceive and respond to people/events around us. If you believe “I should accept my lot in life” and “I’m not good enough”, you will behave very differently from someone who believes “I’m in control of my life” or “I’m learning and growing every single day.”



Most of us cling to our beliefs as if they’re hard truths. In reality, they’re just subjective ideas/beliefs from other people.

- We are born without any preconception of what’s good or bad, easy or difficult, possible or impossible. Everything we believe (e.g. what’s “scary”, “affordable” or “embarrassing”) comes from the people around us. They, in turn, learned their beliefs from others around them.



We’re free to change our beliefs—to drop the unhelpful beliefs and adopt helpful ones. Unfortunately, we’re not always conscious of the underlying beliefs behind our decisions and behaviors.

- Our conscious mind is the logical, analytical part of our brain that processes facts, logic, and decisions. We think we consciously control our lives, when in reality our subconscious mind is the one in charge.
- The subconscious mind is the intuitive part of our brain. It absorbs and stores stimuli from our environment without our conscious awareness.
 - It doesn’t differentiate between what’s “true” or “false”, and believes anything it sees/hears repeatedly. Since the subconscious brain is fully-developed at birth, we start to absorb sights, sounds, and inputs from the day we are born—long before our conscious brain is developed enough to filter or process the inputs. All these are lodged in our subconscious mind to shape our perceptions.
 - If you saw your parents fighting over money and struggling to make ends meet, you may unknowingly develop

KEY QUOTES

“Most people are living in an illusion based on someone else’s beliefs.”

“Our conscious mind thinks it’s in control, but it isn’t. Our subconscious mind doesn’t think about anything, but is in control.”

beliefs like “money brings pain” or “it’s hard to make money”. Such subconscious beliefs can work against you, so you struggle to make money no matter how hard you work.



When things are going badly, you can always find self-sabotaging beliefs contributing to the situation. To remove such beliefs, you must first become aware of them.



The Law of Attraction



Everything in this universe is made of energy, all of which is interconnected. You can refer to this infinite pool of energy as God, the Universe, Source Energy, Higher Power, or any term you prefer.

- Molecules vibrate at specific frequencies and attract other molecules vibrating at the same frequency. The Law of Attraction says that you attract more of what you think/feel persistently.
 - (i) When you focus on problems/complaints and feel overwhelmed, victimized, angry, or helpless, you vibrate at a *low frequency* to attract more of such people/events.
 - (ii) When you calm your mind, focus on what you want, and take joyful action with confidence and gratitude, you vibrate at a *higher frequency* to attract more of what you want.
- A key to success is to believe in the Source Energy and concurrently take action to tap on it. Think in terms of energy, frequency and vibration, and learn to adjust your frequency like how you tune in to a radio station.



One way to do so is to become fully present in the moment.

- We tend to dwell on the past, worry about the future, and get so caught up with our goals/worries that we miss what’s right in front of us. We work so hard for our children’s future that we neglect to spend time with them now. We complain so much about what we don’t want that we lose sight of what we do want.

KEY QUOTES

“The first key to ridding yourself of limiting subconscious beliefs is to become aware of them.”

“The Universe will match whatever vibration you put out. And you can’t fool The Universe.”

- Often, what we want already exists. We just can't see it because we're too caught up with the endless chatter in our minds. Consider this: electricity existed long before humans discovered it and invented the light-bulb to tap on the energy. Once you're fully present and connected to the Source, you too can discover new paths to the life you want.



Negative Self-Perceptions



Whenever you try to step out of your comfort zone, your Ego or shadow self will throw up mental, emotional, and physical barriers.

- This is the inner critic that restricts you with fears and limiting beliefs. It's the voice in your head that says you can't succeed, you shouldn't take risks, or you're unworthy of love and success. Sincero calls it the "Big Snooze".
- By contrast, your higher self embraces new possibilities fearlessly because it has faith in the Universe's abundance, and in your abilities to grow and overcome any challenge.



It takes as much energy to put yourself down as it does to lift yourself up. Why plague yourself with negative self-perceptions when you can celebrate and develop your strengths, talents and potential?



Embracing your Inner Badass



Love and Accept Yourself



Children don't care about singing off-tune, having bad hair, or dancing awkwardly—until we teach them concepts like shame, fear, and self-doubt. Just imagine what you could achieve if you know that you're loved and lovable just as you are.

- Recognize that you're special. There's no one who's exactly like you, with the same talents, experiences, or way of thinking.

KEY QUOTES

"All of those high-frequency things and experiences are already here, just waiting for you to join the party, all you have to do is shut up, show up, and usher them in."

*"Wanting to be someone else is a waste of the person you are."
—Kurt Cobain*

"It's just as easy to believe we're awesome as it is to believe we're giant sucking things."

- Flood yourself with positive affirmations like: "I deserve and receive love every moment everyday" or "My heart is open. Love pours in and out." Display them on post-it notes, play them in your car, and read them to yourself every morning and night.
- Replace negative thoughts or behaviors once you notice them, e.g. replace "I'm such a failure", with "I slipped up but I'm learning from it."
- Drop the self-deprecating jokes. Your subconscious mind believes anything it sees/hears repeatedly.
- Accept love and compliments graciously. Stop comparing with others.
- Forgive yourself for any mistakes or perceived shortcomings. If you feel you've wronged someone, then apologize to them.
- Don't focus only on others' needs and demands. Make time for the things and people you love, and take care of your body.



Don't Worry About Others' Opinions



When you attempt anything significant in life, you will meet with disapproval, rejection, or even ridicule. Stop living in fear of what others think, and start being true to yourself.

- You can't control others' opinions, but you can take responsibility for what's true and important for you. Ask:
 - (i) Is this something I want to be, do, or have?
 - (ii) Does this take me in the direction I want to go?
 - (iii) Will this harm anyone else in the process?
- Accept constructive inputs without being defined by them. When you receive a praise or criticism, pause to consider if it's true. If so, use it to improve yourself or help others. If not, just let it go.
- So long as you're doing your best, you should be proud of yourself regardless of what others think/say.

KEY QUOTES

"When we're happy and all in love with ourselves, we can't be bothered with the bullshit (our own or other people's)."

"Give yourself the gift of a joyous life while you're still among the living."

"All that matters is what's true for you, and if you can stay connected to that without straying, you will be a mighty superhero."

"What other people think about you has nothing to do with you and everything to do with them."

- Find a role model who inspires you. Consider what that person would do, until you're confident to follow your own guidance.
- Don't worry about losing your tribe's approval or acceptance. You can always find another tribe that will embrace you as you are.



Discover Your Calling



Figure out what your unique gifts/talents are, then share them bravely with the world. Live on purpose to enjoy a fulfilling, abundant life.

- Look at yourself from a third-party perspective. What talents, resources, possibilities, and opportunities would you see?
- Don't overthink. Just take a first step and keep moving in the direction that feels right to you. You'll progressively learn about yourself and your calling as you grow and evolve.
- Get ideas from people around you. What aspects of their work or lives interest and excite you? Are you excited by the freedom of working alone, or by the joy of collaborating with a team? Do you like doing something physical with your hands, or using all 5 senses to create something new?
- Spend ≥ 5 min per day connecting with yourself. Sit quietly with yourself and listen to your inner guidance (on who you are, what you love, and what you truly want).
- Our fantasies—however outrageous—shed some light about our dreams. Occasionally follow your fantasies and reach for the stars! What would you do if there were no constraints? What might the best version of yourself be like?

KEY QUOTES

"When we share what we were brought here to give, we are in alignment with our highest, most powerful selves."

"Follow what feels good in the moment, every moment, and it will lead you through a most excellent life."

"Our fantasies are our realities in an excuse-free world."



Tap Into the Source Energy



Practice Meditation



The goal of meditation is to be still and to clear your mind. This allows you to relax, be aware of your inner voice, and connect to the Source Energy. If you're new to meditation, try practicing for just for 5-10 minutes daily, then gradually extend the duration.

- Here are the basics for meditation:
 - (i) Sit comfortably in a chair, or cross-legged on the floor. Place your hands on your knees or lap.
 - (ii) Sit straight and relax your entire face and body.
 - (iii) You can close your eyes or gaze softly at a spot 2 feet ahead.
 - (iv) Focus on your breathing, noticing how it moves in and out of your body.
 - (v) Whenever a thought surfaces, gently release it and clear your mind. Notice any intuitions that surface.
- You can also use these additional tips:
 - (i) Set a timer so you needn't think about the time.
 - (ii) If you need a focal point, let your eyes rest on a candle flame.
 - (iii) Instead of focusing on your breathing, imagine a beam of light shining down from the sky, through your head to the rest of your body, and back to the sky again in a full circle.
 - (iv) If you can't silence the mental chatter, try using guided meditation or a mantra (e.g. repeating "love" or "om").
 - (v) Ideally, do your practice first thing in the morning before other distractions can creep in.
 - (vi) You can seek insight/guidance on an issue by asking a question before or after a meditation, then allow the answer to come to you.

KEY QUOTES

"You have all the answers you need, you just need to give them the chance to get through to you."



Change Your Thoughts to Change Your Reality



Everything we create in reality must first exist as a thought. For something to happen, you must first believe it can happen. Don't insist on seeing the evidence before you believe in something. It's alright if you don't know how to achieve your dreams and goals yet. Your job is to know what you want, then allow the Universe to guide you on the "how".

- Quieten your mind, so you have a clear, uncluttered space to visualize and ask for what you want.
- Create a vision board that captures the details of your vision. Place it where you'll see it daily to freeze the image in your mind.
- Live your vision as if you've already achieved it. If you want to become a Presidential aide, then imagine yourself working in the White House or attending meetings alongside the President. Gather information and pictures about the role and put yourself in situations where you must act the part and meet with people you'd work with.
- Upgrade your environment within your means. If you can't afford to buy a new house, at least tidy up your home or give it a fresh coat of paint.
- Surround yourself with people who inspire you and have achieved what you wish to achieve. Stay away from blamers, complainers and whiners.



Reconnect With Your Inner Child



As children, we were full of joy and wonder. Then, we grow up and start to become serious and uptight. Free your inner child to live/dream joyfully, and have some fun without constantly worrying about your image or responsibilities.

- Stop fretting over what you mustn't or shouldn't do. Push the boundaries and see what you can get away with. Ask "why not?"

KEY QUOTES

"Your job isn't to know the how, it's to know the what and to be open to discovering, and receiving, the how."

"The moment you have the audacity to start believing in the not-yet seen, your reality will begin to shift."

"Being around inspired, visionary, enthusiastic people who are living their truths is one of the fastest ways to massively transform your life."

- Pay attention to the times when you get in flow, i.e. you're so absorbed in something that you lose track of time. What were you doing? How can you create more opportunities to do what you love?
- Be both an Expert and a Beginner. You can improve yourself, yet laugh at your mistakes and have fun.
- Stop fighting your circumstances and learn to go with the flow of life. Find joys in frustrating or unexpected situations.



Give and Receive Freely



The more you give, the more you receive, because you're creating a positive flow of energy. The opposite happens when you cling on to what you have.

- Contribute to 1-2 meaningful causes each month.
- Give away something you love to someone who'd appreciate it.
- Leave a bigger tip than usual.
- When someone is unpleasant, respond with love and care instead of retaliation.
- Smile, compliment people, and make others smile.
- Accept invitations and gifts graciously.



Practice Gratitude



Appreciate the good things and people in your life to attract more of it.

- Greet people politely, say "please" or "thank you", and be thankful for the good things that haven't yet manifested but are on the way to you. This puts you at the right frequency to receive what you want more easily.
- By contrast, when you take things for granted and complain incessantly, it reduces your frequency and cuts you off from the things you want.

KEY QUOTES

"Take the pressure off and get back in on the adventure."

"Giving is one of our greatest joys. It's also one of the most fearless and powerful gestures there is."

"You cut yourself off from the supply of awesomeness when you are not in a state of gratitude."



Practice gratitude daily:

- In any encounter, focus on the positives instead of lamenting on the negatives.
- Each night before going to bed, write down 10 things you're grateful for.



Practice Forgiveness



Don't protract your emotional pain by clinging to resentment, guilt and self-loathing. Forgive others for yourself, not for them. Let go of your negative feelings to gain a sense of freedom, and stop wasting energy on people/issues that make you feel bad.

- Why hang on to beliefs or attachments that bring you pain? Choose to be happy, not to be right. If you must, throw a private tantrum to get it out of your system, then move on.
- Find compassion: think of the other person as a child who acted poorly because he/she didn't know how to handle the situation.
- Ask if there could be other explanations for what happened, e.g. the other person wasn't ignoring your calls but had lost his phone.
- Remove the person from the picture, so you stop wasting energy thinking about them or how they've wronged you. Free yourself to move on without them.



Stop Sabotaging Yourself



Change Your Stories



Often, we create stress and drama unintentionally. We focus on fears/limitations, blow problems out of proportion, then rush around frantically and bump against the walls. If we just calmed

KEY QUOTES

"You cannot exercise much power without gratitude; for it is gratitude that keeps you connected with Power."

—Wallace Wattles

"Holding on to resentment is like taking poison and waiting for your enemies to die."

"Do yourself a favor and use irritating situations and people as opportunities for growth, not pain."

down and studied the situation, we could've found a door and simply walked through it.



Statements like "Nobody cares about me" or "I'm hopeless at this" are not truths. They're just stories that you tell yourself, and you can rewrite your stories:

- Make a list of your stories and excuses. They usually begin with words like: "I always", "I never", "I cannot", "I should", "I'm bad at", "I wish", or "Someday".
- Identify the false benefits you're getting from each story. For instance, are you saying that you're bad at making money to get someone's attention, or to avoid taking responsibility for your finances?
- Consciously let go of old excuses, attachments, and unhelpful beliefs. Replace each one with new empowering statements that help you to imagine a life of joy, power and freedom. For example, replace "I'm bad with money" with "I can handle large sums of money" or "My capacity to earn, hold and grow money expands every day."
- Build new habits. Start behaving as if you're already the person living the new stories. Break your old routines, e.g. wear something different, or expose yourself to new places, people, and experiences. You'll realize that the new reality and opportunities existed all along—you just had to start looking in the right places.



Stop Procrastinating



Procrastination is a form of self-sabotage. Why waste energy coming up with excuses, when you can use the energy to just get it done?

- It's better to have a less-than-perfect interim output, than to wait indefinitely for a "perfect" solution that's never completed.
- Take note of where you tend to falter or quit. Try smoothening the process by hiring someone to handle that task.
- Get someone to hold you accountable, e.g. donate \$1000 to a charity if you fail to meet your deadline.

KEY QUOTES

"What you choose to focus on becomes your reality."

"Life is an illusion created by your perception, and it can be changed the moment you choose to change it."

"If you're serious about changing your life, you'll find a way. If you're not, you'll find an excuse."

- If you tend to put off your tasks until the last minute because you work better under pressure, then work with your tendencies. Know the latest date/time you must start, then allow yourself to enjoy or do other things until the time is up.



Stop Feeling Overwhelmed



When we work ourselves into a frenzy, it only hinders our own performance. Tackle 3 common illusions to regain control of your time/energy.

- Not enough time: You can always find time if you want or have to.
 - Respect time to have more of it. Turn up for appointments on time, honor your deadlines, and stop wasting others' time.
 - Identify your biggest time-wasters (e.g. social media, emails) and make them as inaccessible as possible.
 - Break down big projects into bite-sized tasks. Work for focused periods of up to 60 minutes, followed by a break.
- Too much to do: Do what you can with joy, rather than drown yourself trying to do everything.
 - Stop saying how busy you are. Focus on the time you *do* have, and how it feels to do what you enjoy.
 - Focus on the things that must be done *now*, and use your prime hours to tackle the most important tasks first. Then, delegate or reschedule the rest.
- Too tired: You can't perform optimally when you're exhausted. Take some time to rest, recover and recharge to protect your health.



Overcome your Fears



It's normal to be afraid when you're trying something new or challenging. Fear is just a feeling—you can manage it instead of allowing it to rule your life.

KEY QUOTES

"Life is but a dream. Don't turn it into a nightmare."

"Do what you can do in joy, instead of trying to do it all in misery."

"Help is all around us, sometimes receiving it is simply a matter of looking at it differently, or not giving up so easily."

- Recall a past event that you were scared of. Does it still look scary on hindsight? Then, consider if you're in any danger right now. You'd realize that fear exists purely in your mind and the imaginary events you fear may never happen.
- Flip the fear to your advantage. If you dare not try public speaking because you're afraid of looking silly, consider how silly you'd feel at your deathbed for allowing your fear to rule you.
- Manage your media diet. Read, watch, and listen to materials that offer a positive, realistic view of the world, not excessive negativity, fear, or pain.
- Before sleeping, meditate to clear your mind of problems and focus on what you're grateful for. Get a good night's rest so you have the energy to face a new day.



See Others As Your Mirrors



The people around us serve as mirrors to reflect back something about ourselves. What we like or dislike about others is always a reflection of what we like or dislike about ourselves.

- Stop projecting onto others, and start to own your flaws.
 - (i) Pay attention to the things that drive you crazy. If you get triggered by people who break their promises, ask: In what ways do I break my own promises? What fears or insecurities do I have about broken promises?
 - (ii) Dig deeper to identify the false benefits you gain from being that way. Then, ask who you must become for this to stop bothering you.
- Walk away from toxic people. Don't keep bailing them out or they'll never learn to handle their own problems. If you're truly helping or empowering someone, it should make everyone feel good (not heavy or resentful).

KEY QUOTES

"On the other side of your fear is your freedom."

"If you want to help the world and yourself, keep your frequency high and do your work from a place of power and joy."

"The people you surround yourself with are excellent mirrors for who you are and how much, or how little, you love yourself."

"Never apologize for who you are. It lets the whole world down."

*"No one can make you feel inferior without your consent."
—Eleanor Roosevelt*



Start Moving Toward Your Best Life



Make a Real Decision Now



You only have 1 life. Don't wait until you have more time, money, or experience to do what you want to do, or to enjoy the people you love. You know you've made a real, non-negotiable decision when you feel deep in your gut you'll get it done, no matter what.

- Crystalize the outcomes you want badly enough to drive you to take persistent action.
- Learn to be more decisive by practicing on smaller decisions. For example, choose where/what to eat within 30 seconds, and choose your grocery items within 10 seconds each.
- Once you've made a decision, stop negotiating. Don't give yourself any wiggle room to get out of your commitment.



Make Money Your New Best Friend



Money is more than just a piece of paper. Money is a form of energy. How much money you have reflects your frequency and how you see yourself.



Follow these 3 rules of wealth:

- Have an abundance mindset, not a scarcity mindset. Stop playing small, and thinking that you can't afford the things you want. Raise your frequency by playing big and having faith in yourself and the Universe. Use phrases like: "I can" or "There's more than enough".
- Most people wish to have more money but don't believe they can have it. They justify their lack of money by saying they don't need it, or that money is bad. Write down your stories about money and the false benefits you're clinging to.

KEY QUOTES

"Your life is happening right now. Do not snooze and lose."

"So often, we pretend we've made a decision, when what we've really done is signed up to try until it gets too uncomfortable."

"Money is currency and currency is energy."

"Making money isn't only about the money...It's about who you become and what you believe is possible for yourself."

"The more you have, the more you have to share."

Use affirmations to heal your relationship with money. Accept that money is good, you deserve lots of money, and can use it to do good. Remember: the more money you have, the more you have to give and share.

- Know where you want to be, then take action to make it happen. When our goals are fuzzy, we tend to drag our feet. Once we're clear on what to do and why we want to do it, we move with purpose and urgency.
 - (i) Get crystal clear on your ideal lifestyle, how much you want to make, and why. Your vision should be so vivid that you can see it, feel it, and taste it, as if it's already here.
 - (ii) Think big: What would you do if you had unlimited wealth? How could you use money in a way that makes you feel good about your wealth? What type of person must you become to be worth 1 million, 10 million or 1 billion?
 - (iii) Raise your frequency. Rather than give away your services for free (then struggle to pay your own bills), aim to deliver so much value that others are happy to pay a premium for your services. This way, you can exchange energy at a high level and generate massive wealth to expand your reach/impact.
 - (iv) Raise the bar. Set a minimum figure in your bank account, commit 10% of your earnings to charity, and surround yourself with people and ideas that help you to become the person you wish to be.



Surrender and Receive



Once you've crystallized your vision in detail and done your best to move toward it, surrender energetically and let the Universe show you the best way to reach your goals. Allow what you want to come to you, instead of forcing it to happen in a certain way.

- Stop resisting by worrying, doubting, or insisting on control. Surrender by taking joyful action with the assurance that what you want is already on the way to you. In short, your role is

KEY QUOTES

"Nothing has any value other than the value we put on it."

"Money is an exchange of energy between people."

"In order to create wealth, you must bring yourself into energetic alignment with the money you desire to manifest."

"Energy needs to flow or else it stagnates. Surrendering puts you in the flow."

"Your faith in The Universe must be stronger than your fear of not getting what you want."

to know and convey your desires in no uncertain terms to the Universe. Then, raise your frequency to that desired future by:

- (i) Taking joyful, passionate action toward it;
- (ii) Thinking and behaving as if you already have that future;
- (iii) Meditating and practicing gratitude to stay connected with Source Energy and your desired future; and
- (iv) Loving yourself.



Other Details in the Book to Look out For

The ideas in this book cannot be fully grasped at a logical or conceptual level. You can only *experience* them through real-life application. So, be open-minded enough to just try out the concepts and strategies above. With each epiphany, you'll uncover even more things to learn/grasp in order to move to the next higher level.

This book is written in an upbeat, "go-get-'em" tone with lots of personal anecdotes, humor, and the occasional curse words. For more tips and resources, please visit <https://jensincero.com/>.



About the Author



Jen Sincero (born 1965) is an American writer, speaker and success coach. Before becoming a writer and starting her own coaching practice, she worked as a marketer at CBS/Epic Records, and co-founded/played in several rock bands. *You Are A Badass* is Sincero's 3rd book, which became a bestseller and led to several spinoffs including *You Are a Badass at Making Money*, *You Are a Badass Everyday* and *Badass Habits*.

KEY QUOTES

"When you believe that everything you desire already exists, you are in a natural state of surrender."